


**8%** Increase in allocation for agriculture and allied activities, up from ₹1.41 lakh cr. in FY24 (RE) to ₹1.52 lakh cr. in FY25

PRABHJOT GILL

led to a rethink. Assembly polls are due in Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Haryana and J&K later this year, and the party think-tanks were expecting Sitharaman to ease their load a bit. Sources say they believe she missed an opportunity in not increasing the payout in the income support scheme for poorer farmers (PM-Kisan Samman Nidhi scheme). It continues to be Rs 6,000 annually, which was set in 2018. A big sticking point with farmers could also be the cut in fertiliser subsidy, down to Rs 1.64 lakh crore; actual expenditure in 2022-23 was Rs 2.5 lakh crore. (The Centre claims it was rationalised to factor in the softening commodity prices.)

The agri sector inherits three big challenges in Modi 3.0—the failed crop diversification attempts to high-yielding and climate-friendly produce,

## SEED MONEY



**₹3.8 LAKH CRORE**
($46.44 billion) The value of agri food exports (including processed) in 2023-24, making up 11.7% of India's total exports




**75 MN**
No. of Kisan Credit Cards (KCC) issued till Jan 31, 2024, with a credit limit of Rs 9.4 lakh cr. Collateral-free loan limit enhanced



**61 MN HA.**
Insured farmland area in 2023-24 under Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana, up 11 mn ha. from previous year



**555 MN**
No. of farmers insured since 2016-17. Claims worth over Rs 1.5 lakh crore settled



**12.02%**
Share of food processing in total employment in the organised manufacturing sector

*Source: Economic Survey 2023-24*